

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 721

By Moon

A RESOLUTION to recognize Master Sergeant Rachel J. Wilson on the occasion of her retirement from the United States Air Force.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly take great pleasure in honoring those members of the United States military who, throughout their distinguished careers, have served with honor, bravery, and an unswerving commitment to duty; and

WHEREAS, one such individual is Master Sergeant Rachel J. Wilson of the United States Air Force, who is taking her much-deserved retirement from active military service after proudly defending our nation; and

WHEREAS, Master Sergeant Wilson has most recently served as a 3D072, Cyber Systems Operations Craftsman/Systems Administrator Supervisor, assigned to the 119th Cyberspace Operations Squadron, McGhee Tyson Air National Guard Base Louisville, Tennessee; and

WHEREAS, she enlisted in the U.S. Army Reserve on June 3, 2003, as a Private, E-1, and attended basic training at Fort Jackson, where she graduated on the Commandant's List; after advanced training at Fort Leonard Wood, she served with pride and distinction as a convoy escort gunner during operation Iraqi Freedom in 2005; and

WHEREAS, after being promoted to Private, E-2, on June 7, 2024, she rose through the ranks, serving as Private First Class, E-3; Specialist, E-4; Army Sergeant, E-5; Army Staff Sergeant, E-6; Air Force Staff Sergeant, E-5; Air Force Technical Sergeant, E-6; and Air Force Master Sergeant, E-7; and

WHEREAS, in 2013, Master Sergeant Wilson voluntarily reduced in rank to join the Tennessee Air National Guard; she returned to McGhee Tyson, where she was assigned to

Combat Operations Division in the Cyber Reporting Cell, and during this time, she provided key analytical support to the Air Force Cyber mission set; and

WHEREAS, in 2016, Master Sergeant Rachel Wilson was reassigned to Network Defense, where she served as a Cyber Systems Operations specialist, and she distinguished herself through outstanding service while deployed to the 624th Operations Center, Kelly Annex San Antonio, Texas, achieving a 98 percent on the 624th Mission Qualification Evaluation and receiving her Mission Ready status in record time; and

WHEREAS, immediately earning the trust and respect of her active-duty counterparts, she played a direct role in the realignment of Air Force Information Network Enterprise Change Management operations, working with her team to maintain the highest standards of Air Force Cyber Security while also serving the individual mission requirements of Air Force units worldwide; and

WHEREAS, in 2017, Master Sergeant Wilson was selected for retraining into the 1B4X1 career field, Cyber Warfare Operations Apprentice, with duties and responsibilities including monitoring, detecting, and destroying adversarial cyber threats within the Air Force Information Network; coordinating with Air Force tactical units and external agencies for all mission tasking execution; and supporting network maintenance and enhancing mission capabilities for all Air Force units through effective implementation of the Enterprise change management process; and

WHEREAS, Master Sergeant Rachel Wilson rendered sterling service in all her military assignments, which included the 465th Army Transportation Company, Pennsylvania (2003-2005); the 465th Army Transportation Company, Camp Anaconda, Iraq (2005-2006); the 2nd BN 310th Training Regiment, Fort Devens, Massachusetts (2006-2009); the Army Regional Training Center – East, Fort Dix, New Jersey (2009-2013); and, beginning in 2013, the 119th Cyberspace Operations Squadron, McGhee Tyson Air National Guard Base, Tennessee; and

WHEREAS, her professional military education includes being a Cyber Systems Operations Specialist Distinguished Graduate, Keesler Air Force Base, Mississippi; completing Airman Leadership School; taking a Cyber Warfare Operations Course, Keesler Air Force Base, Mississippi; and completing Non-Commissioned Officer Academy; and

WHEREAS, Master Sergeant Wilson was honored with a number of awards and decorations, including the Air Force Commendation Medal, Army Commendation Medal with oak leaf cluster, Air Force Achievement Medal, Army Achievement Medal with four oak leaf clusters, and Combat Readiness Medal; and

WHEREAS, throughout her distinguished career, Master Sergeant Rachel Wilson has served these United States with honor and distinction, and it is wholly fitting that we recognize her on the occasion of her retirement from military service; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor and commend Master Sergeant Rachel J. Wilson upon her retirement from the United States Air Force, as we extend our gratitude for her many years of selfless service and our best wishes for her every future happiness and success.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.